



Rocket League drop Linux, Mac

The popular video game is dropping multiplayer support for both Linux and Mac. <https://digit.in/feb20-65>



Altered Carbon returns for S2

Futuristic Netflix Sci-Fi series, Altered Carbon, will be returning for season 2 on February 27. <https://digit.in/feb20-66>

ZTE Nubia Red Magic 3s

Handheld console more than a smartphone

After launching the Red Magic 3, Nubia quickly refreshed it with the Red Magic 3s in a bid to keep up with the recent flurry of flagships that came with the specially binned processor Qualcomm made to boost mobile gaming. The major upgrades from the Red Magic 3 are the presence of the Snapdragon 855+ and UFS 3.0 storage. Both these components should go a long way in improving usability. Let's find out if they do.

Design and display

The Nubia Red Magic 3s looks and feels like a gaming smartphone. It has the grooves, cuts and sharp edges. There's also an RGB strip down the middle at the back, and the single 48MP camera is shaped to add symmetry to the overall design.

Coming to the display, the Red Magic 3s sports a 6.65-inch AMOLED display with 90Hz refresh rate. The display is exactly the same as the Red Magic 3, and just like before, the panel doesn't hold a candle to the ones on the OnePlus 7T Pro or the ROG Phone II. The Red Magic 3s' panel looks dull and manages to only hit 476 lux max brightness outside in the day.

Camera

The single 48MP Sony IMX586 rear sensor on the phone is well-optimised. There are some interesting features to check out in the Red Magic 3s camera app such as 8K video recording.

As for the photos themselves, the images taken outdoors came out bright and vivid with just the right amount of sharpness. There's no ultrawide or a portrait mode here. The best you have is an electronic aperture mode that simulates depth of field using software. It's not very helpful though. Also, the camera tends to boost the ISO every time you take a binned photo at 12MP.



Price
₹35,999



BUILD AND DESIGN.....	62
PERFORMANCE.....	72
FEATURES.....	65
VALUE.....	68

Software

The Red Magic 3s relies on a custom skin developed by Nubia which looks quite dated. The UI lacks the smoothness we expect from high-end smartphones. Animations and transitions don't feel as smooth despite having a 90Hz refresh

rate. The good thing is the Red Magic 3s doesn't come with a lot of bloatware.

Performance

The Snapdragon 855+ on the Red Magic 3s is binned at a higher speed and sports an overclocked GPU. Furthermore, UFS 3.0 storage promises a 2x increase in read/write speeds over UFS 2.1 used in the Red Magic 3. The Red Magic 3s is faster than its predecessor on all the benchmarks. But when pegged against other Snapdragon 855+-powered smartphones, the Red Magic 3s isn't always the best. It scored the best on Geekbench Single Core and Multi Core CPU tests, but on AnTuTu and 3DMark Slingshot, it did lag behind the likes of the OnePlus 7T, Asus ROG Phone II and the Realme X2 Pro. But the difference is minimal.

We also tried out a few resource-intensive games, and clocked the frame rates and stability using Gamebench. We ran

the games within Nubia's gaming mode. The game mode turns on the fan inside, lets you tweak the CPU and GPU clocks, pair a gamepad to the phone and more. Games ran just as well as they would on other SD855+ smartphones. For instance, most games managed to hit peak frame rates but the stability differed. Tasks other than games, however, are plagued by bugs. Apps like Facebook, Instagram and Messenger are not quite optimised.

The Red Magic 3s comes with a big 5,000mAh battery. There's also support for 18W fast charging. Now, Nubia claimed you can play almost eight hours of PUBG Mobile on a single charge, and that claim holds true only if you play on the auto mode. Tweaking the GPU and CPU frequencies to run at peak speeds will drain the battery much faster. Overall, keeping everything running at its max, the Red Magic 3s dropped around 6 percent while playing PUBG Mobile for 15 minutes, while 30 minutes of Netflix drained the battery by 8 percent.

Bottomline

With most things remaining the same with only the SoC and storage getting an upgrade, the Red Magic 3s is definitely faster but the experience remains largely the same. As far as gaming smartphones go, the experience is somewhat inferior to the ROG Phone II. Yes, the price too is slightly lower, but paying a little more gets you a lot more features, accessories and far more robust hardware-software integration. Still, the Red Magic 3s ran almost every game we threw at it at peak frame rates even though it struggles a bit to get the daily tasks right, so it's not a great daily driver.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.65-inch AMOLED | RESOLUTION: 1080 x 2340 pixels | OS: Android 9.0 (Pie); Redmagic 2.0 | CHIPSET: Qualcomm Snapdragon 855+ (7 nm) | CPU: Octa-core | GPU: Adreno 640 (700 MHz) | INTERNAL STORAGE: 128GB/8GB RAM, 256GB/12GB RAM | CAMERA: 48 MP | SELFIE CAMERA: 16 MP | BLUETOOTH: 5.0 | FINGERPRINT SENSOR: Yes (rear-mounted) | BATTERY: Non-removable Li-Po 5000 mAh, Fast battery charging 18W, Quick Charge 4+

CONTACT

ZTE INDIA | PHONE: 1800-102-5068 | EMAIL: cscindia@zte.com.cn | WEBSITE: <https://www.zte.com.cn/global/>